

specification ensures that devices have a 128-bit key. That, combined with a cipher for encryption, ensures that a Bluetooth device is as secure as a wire-based connection. However, this still does not prevent data theft.

Another rather creative use of these Bluetooth networks is for viral advertising or campaigning which has come to be called Bluetooth hijacking or Bluejacking. Bluejacking involves Bluetooth users sending a business card, text message, audio, video or other data to other Bluetooth users within a 10-metre radius.



Bluejacking

If the user doesn't realise what the message is, he might allow the contact to be added to his address book, and the contact can send him messages that might be automatically opened because they're coming from a known contact. Most Bluetooth users don't suspect this and it has been used successfully for viral advertising. Bluesnarfing is a term given to Bluetooth hacking. The downside to Bluetooth popularity is that there are a lot of viruses, malware and trojan horse programs that can infect and attack Bluetooth devices.

5.2 Bluetooth versions

Since the creation of Bluetooth in 1994, and its subsequent marketing post 1997, several strides have been made in development.

As one might expect, the first Bluetooth versions 1.0 and 1.0B had quite a few problems, especially when it came to inter-operability between different manufacturers of electronic devices.

Bluetooth 1.1 was ratified as part of IEEE Standard 802.15.1-2002. The IEEE is an international organisation for electronic and electrical engineers and is often responsible for initiating standards and protocols. The errors in 1.0B Specification were fixed and there was added support for non-encrypted channels. An indication of the strength of the Bluetooth signal also called